

The Sleepy Lighthouse

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



On a rocky cliff by the sea stood a tall lighthouse. Her name was Luma. Every night she shone her bright beam across the waves. She helped the boats find their way home.

Pela the little puffin lived in a nest nearby. She loved watching Luma's light sweep the sea. But tonight something looked different. Luma's beam was drooping low. It moved very, very slowly.

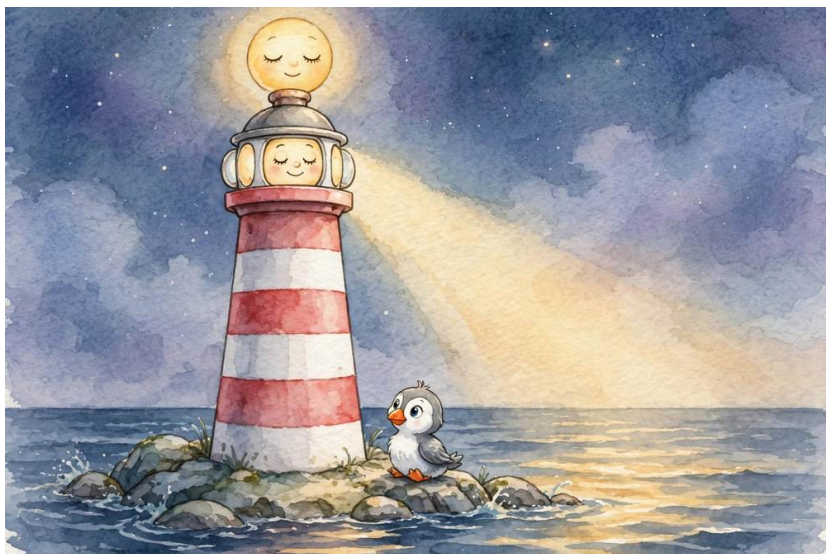
Pela fluttered up to the lighthouse door. "Luma?" she called. "Are you feeling all right?"



Luma's big round light blinked sleepily. "I am so tired, little puffin," she sighed. "I have shone all night, every night, for a hundred years. My light wants to rest."

Pela felt sorry for Luma. She looked out at the sea. Every boat was already home. The fishing boats were tied up tight. The sailboats rocked gently at the dock. No one needed the bright beam tonight.

"You can rest, Luma," said Pela kindly. "All the boats are sleeping too."



"But what if someone needs me?" worried Luma.

"I will keep watch," promised Pela. "I will sit right here. If a boat comes, I will wake you."

Luma felt relieved. She let her bright beam grow dimmer. It turned from bright white to soft gold. It became a gentle nightlight for the waves.

"Shine soft, then sleep," whispered Pela.



Luma's big round eye closed halfway. The beam grew softer still. The waves lapped quietly against the rocks. Pela felt calm watching her friend rest.

"Shine soft, then sleep," Pela whispered again.

Luma's eye closed a little more. Her light was now a warm glow, like a candle. The stars came out to keep the sea company. Pela tucked her head under her wing.

"Shine soft, then sleep," Pela whispered one last time.



Luma's eye closed all the way. Her glow was faint and cozy. The whole cliff felt peaceful. Pela's own eyes grew heavy. She had kept her promise, and now she could rest too.

Sleep now, little lighthouse. Sleep now, little puffin. Even the brightest lights need to close their eyes sometimes.

***Moral:** Even helpers need rest, and it is kind to let them have it.*

The End